

University
of Jeddah
Collage of Computer Science and Engineering



Final Training Report

Department of Software Engineering

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DATE: August 1, 2025

Acknowledgment

I extend my deepest gratitude to Barakah for providing this invaluable internship opportunity. Special thanks to my supervisor, Ms. Ghalia Saad Alnanaih, for her expert guidance and unwavering support throughout my training. Her mentorship profoundly enhanced my UX research and product design skills. I also thank the entire Product Team at Barakah for fostering a collaborative environment where I could contribute meaningfully to real-world projects. This experience has been instrumental in bridging my academic knowledge with industry practices.

Abstract

This report presents a comprehensive overview of my nine-week summer training at Barakah, a forward-thinking digital product company. The training involved various tasks such as user research, usability testing, interface redesign, and technical documentation. Throughout the internship, I collaborated with cross-functional teams, participated in real-time product development, and enhanced my UX and analytical skills. The experience significantly contributed to my understanding of product design workflows and real-world user experience strategies.

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Introduction

Barakah is an innovative Saudi mobile application designed to combat food waste while promoting affordability. The app allows restaurants to sell their fresh, untouched surplus food at significant discounts—often up to 50% or more.

The core idea behind Barakah is to help restaurants dispose of excess food responsibly, while giving consumers the opportunity to purchase high-quality meals at reduced prices. This win-win model blends sustainability with economic value, making Barakah an appealing platform for both businesses and customers.

The app also incorporates smart digital features such as a personalized home screen, order challenges, and rewards programs to encourage engagement and repeat use.

During my summer training at Barakah, I joined the Product team, where I worked on real product initiatives aimed at improving the user experience and optimizing core app features.

My responsibilities included conducting user research, supporting usability testing, contributing to feature design, writing requirement documentation, and collaborating with tech and design teams.

Training Plan

The summer training at Barakah was designed to span 9 weeks, covering a total of 200 hours, during the period from June 15 to August 10, 2025.

The plan was approved by both the company and the academic supervisor, and was aligned with the learning outcomes of the Software Engineering program.

The structure was progressive, starting with onboarding and research preparation, then moving into product feature development, usability testing, cross-functional collaboration, and finally reporting and presentation.

Week	Start Date	Work Description
1	June 15, 2025	Onboarding, tools setup (Figma, Notion, Jira), UX overview, shadowing product/dev team meetings
2	June 22, 2025	UX research fundamentals: personas, interviews, surveys, interview planning,
3	June 29, 2025	Home Screen Personalization – Part 1: journey mapping, benchmarking, planning testing, aligning with stakeholders
4	July 6, 2025	Usability Testing – test execution, feedback analysis
5	July 13, 2025	Writing PRD for personalization + intro to AWS flow, collaborating with backend team, sprint planning participation
6	July 20, 2025	Map View feature – user needs, clustering research, identifying pain points, scoping
7	July 27,	Frontend/backend collaboration, QA testing, improving

	Week Start Date	Work Description
	2025	interaction logic
8	August 3, 2025	In-app Reviews – user feedback evaluation, testing review display logic, drafting enhancement suggestions for core app features
9	August 10, 2025	Quarter planning, internship summary, final presentation

The structure of this training allowed me to build on my skills each week. I started by observing and learning the internal tools and workflows, then gradually moved into contributing actively in research, planning, and implementation of real features.

I also got to explore professional tools like Mixpanel for behavioral analytics and Useberry for remote usability testing, which helped me understand how to make design decisions based on actual user data.

List of Project/Projects or tasks assigned to you with Brief description

Onboarding & Product Familiarization

Attended onboarding sessions, learned Barakah's mission, explored product features, and familiarized with internal tools like Figma, Jira, Notion, and Mixpanel.

UX Research for Rewards Feature

Conducted user research on Barakah's "Order Challenge" feature to understand motivation and dropout behavior. Assisted in preparing interview questions and selecting user segments based on behavioral data.

Home Screen Personalization (Part 1)

Mapped user journeys, analyzed competitor apps, and participated in stakeholder meetings to shape the design of a more personalized home experience.

Usability Testing for Home Screen (Part 2)

Designed usability test scenarios, conducted internal and remote tests (via Useberry), and documented key insights and recommendations for the product team.

PRD Writing & AWS Integration Exploration

Co-authored Product Requirement Documents (PRDs) for the revamped Home and Search experiences. Participated in backend technical walkthroughs to understand data architecture.

Map View Feature Development

Researched map clustering logic and user needs for location-based restaurant views.

Supported scoping and cross-team discussions for frontend and backend implementation.

Review Experience Enhancement

Investigated in-app reviews flow and contributed to improving how user feedback is displayed and managed. Helped with QA testing and feature refinement.

Cross-Team Collaboration & Quarter Planning

Joined product planning meetings to reprioritize backlog tasks, align with different departments, and support planning for the next development quarter.

Main tasks and duties performed during the summer training

Week 1 Progress Report

This week was focused on onboarding, understanding Barakah's mission and culture, and setting up tools like Figma, Notion, Jira, and Slack. I also reviewed previous case studies to grasp the team's research methodology. A key part of the week was being introduced to Mixpanel, a powerful analytics tool, where I learned how to extract user segments to support upcoming research.

Challenges Faced: The main challenge was learning multiple tools like Jira and Figma simultaneously. Grasping the full scope of Barakah's products in a short time also required focused effort.

Skills Learned and Benefits: I became confident in using collaboration tools and understood how UX fits into the team's workflow. Learning Mixpanel gave me a strong foundation in user analytics, which was directly applicable to identifying interview candidates.

Completed Hours: 23 hours

Week 2 Progress Report

This week, my focus was on UX research fundamentals and applying them to the new "Rewards" feature. I learned about usability testing methods, user persona

development, and interview planning. Using Mixpanel, I identified and screened 40 users who had either completed the challenge or dropped off early. I created tailored interview questions to understand their motivations and challenges. I supported the team in reaching out to these users with the goal of conducting interviews.

Challenges Faced: I encountered a low response rate from users, which was challenging and emotionally draining.

Skills Learned and Benefits: I gained hands-on experience in screening and planning interviews, and learned how to extract valuable qualitative insights from behavioral data. My user communication skills also significantly improved.

Completed Hours: 23 hours

	A	B	C	D
1	Section / Category	Questions		
2		Objective is to understand what motivated them to complete all the milestones and what worked well in their experience.		
3	Motivation & Experience	What made you decide to join the Rewards Challenge in June?	إلى أي دافعت أو سحره تشرك في إحدى المئات في يونيو	
4		What motivated you to keep ordering until the final milestone?	إلى أي حركه تومل القلب بين وسعت الفرصة الأخيرة؟	
5		How did you feel about the milestone reward amounts (eg, 10 SAR at M4, 5 SAR at M5, 15 SAR at M6)?	إلى أي ركة في مبلغ المئات عند كل مرحلة؟ أملاً 10 ريال عند المرحلة 4، 5 ريال عند الخامسة، و15 ريال عند السادسة	
6		Were you more motivated by the rewards or the purpose (including food waste)?	إلى أي حركه أكثر؟ البوتيرة الهدء من السدي إلى التقل حذر لأكبر؟	
7	App Experience	Was it easy to track your milestone progress?	هل كان سهل علك أنك تتبع تقدمك في الأميال؟	
8		Did you receive enough reminders or updates during the challenge?	هل وسلك تذكارات أو تحديثات كافية أثناء السدي؟	
9		Was there anything that made it easier for you to reach the milestones?	في شيء ساعدك أو سهل علك تومل المراحل؟	
10	Improvements + NPS	What would make the experience even better?	إلى أي ممكن يائي التجربة أحسن؟	
11		Was there any point where you almost dropped out? What kept you going?	في وقت حثيت إلك لتسحب؟ وإلى أي ذلك تملك؟	
12		Would you join another challenge? Why or why not?	هل ستسهم لعض مرة أخرى أم لا؟	
13		Rate from 0-10	قيم التجربة من 0 إلى 10	
14				

Figure 1 Questions for users who have completed the 7 milestones

	A	B	C	D
1	Section / Category	Questions		
2		Objective is to understand why they dropped off, what friction points existed, and how rewards could be improved.		
3	Enrollment	What made you decide to join the June challenge?	ما الذي حركه للمشاركة في إحدى شهر يونيو؟	
4		How far did you expect to go when you first joined?	إلى أي مدى كنت تتوقع أن تعمل عندما انضمت لأول مرة	
5	Drop-off Reasons	What stopped you from continuing further?	ما الذي منعتك من الاستمرار؟	
6		Was it about the rewards, the experience, or something else?	هل كان السبب منعتك بالمئات، أم بالتجربة أم بآخر ذلك؟	
7		Did anything about the app or the communication make it hard to stay engaged?	هل كان شيء في التطبيق أو في طريقة التواصل جعلك تجد صعوبة في الاستمرار؟	
8	Reward Perception	Did the reward amounts feel worth it for the effort?	هل شعرت أن المئات كانت تستحق الجهد المبذول؟	
9		Was the reward structure (eg, Milestone 2 = 10 SAR) clear to you?	هل كان هيك المئات واضحاً وبأسية لك؟ أملاً المرحلة 2 = 10 ريال	
10		Would smaller but more frequent rewards have helped?	هل كانت المئات الأصغر ولكن المتكررة ستساعد أكثر؟	
11	Improvements + NPS	What would have made you stay longer in the challenge?	ما الذي كان من الممكن أن يجعلك تستمر لفترة أطول في السدي؟	
12		Would you consider joining another challenge? Why or why not?	هل تملك في الانضمام إلى تحد أخرى أم لا؟	
13		Rate from 0-10	قيم المئات من 0 إلى 10	
14				

Figure 2 Questions for users who dropped off

Week 3 Progress Report

This week, I began working on the Personalization Home Screen feature. My role involved mapping the user journey, conducting a competitor analysis, and aligning the project scope with stakeholders. A key task was redesigning the restaurant "Bag cards" to improve readability and creating horizontal scrolling sections based on Mixpanel insights, as users showed more engagement with these formats. I also prepared usability testing questions to better understand user needs.

Challenges Faced: Balancing stakeholder priorities with business requirements and user needs was a main challenge. The competitor analysis was also time-consuming due to the variety of personalization strategies. I also faced challenges in finding the right balance for the layout and curating themed sections that were relevant to Barakah users.

Skills Learned and Benefits: This experience improved my communication and negotiation skills, as I learned to synthesize business needs with user goals. My analytical thinking was sharpened through studying other apps. The process of preparing usability test questions also enhanced my ability to think from a user's perspective. I improved my UI design and iteration practices, and learned how to apply product analytics to shape the interface.

Completed Hours: 23 hours

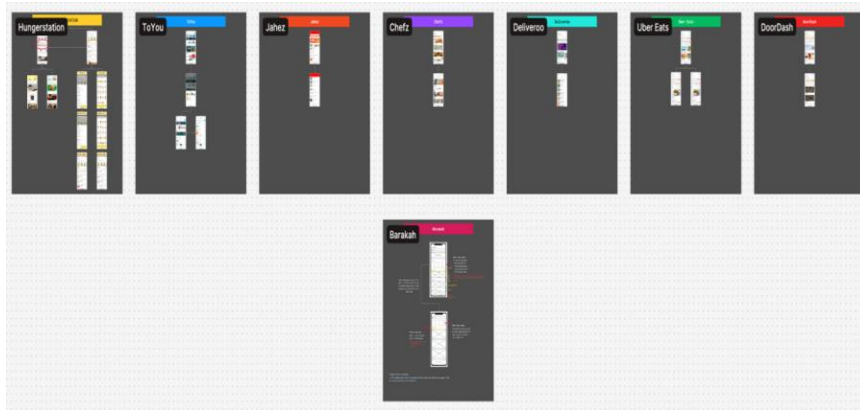


Figure 3Competitive analysis

Week 4 Progress Report

This week was dedicated to usability testing for the personalization feature. I designed test scenarios and conducted internal usability sessions with team members, receiving positive feedback. We then planned for testing with real users, but faced challenges with last-minute cancellations. We pivoted to Useberry, a remote testing platform, and I helped set up the flow. Technical issues with the platform prevented us from completing the tests, but we planned to finalize them in Week 6.

Challenges Faced: Scheduling users and conducting unbiased testing was difficult. We also faced technical issues with the remote testing platform.

Skills Learned and Benefits: This experience significantly improved my ability to observe user behavior and translate qualitative feedback into design improvements. I also gained experience with remote usability testing tools and strengthened my adaptability in research planning.

Completed Hours: 23 hours

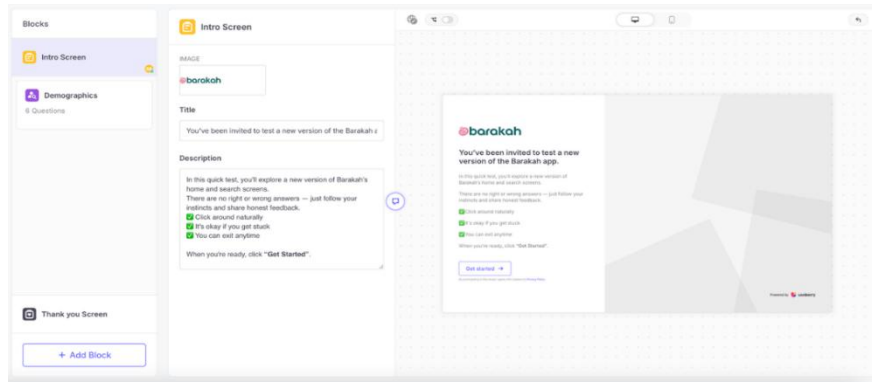


Figure 4 Useberry platform

Week 5 Progress Report

This week, I was tasked with helping to draft the Product Requirements Document (PRD) for the personalization feature. I collaborated closely with the product manager to organize technical and business details and joined backend technical walkthroughs to understand how the personalization engine connects with user data via AWS. I also observed how the product team plans sprints using Jira. Additionally, I contributed to the vendor self-onboarding project by planning vendor interviews and usability tests to uncover issues.

Challenges Faced: The technical terminology and complexity of AWS were new to me and took time to grasp. Writing a clear and concise PRD that was understood by both business and technical teams was a learning curve. Due to the usability testing delays from Week 4, we were unable to complete testing this week, and the sessions were rescheduled for Week 6.

Skills Learned and Benefits: This week strengthened my documentation skills and expanded my understanding of how design decisions impact backend development. I

Completed Hours: 23 hours



Week 6 Progress Report

This week marked the beginning of the scoping phase for the new Map View feature, which aims to help users explore restaurants geographically. I began by conducting research to understand how users currently discover restaurants and what limitations they face with the existing Browse interface. To gain a competitive edge, I performed a competitive benchmark against apps like Hungerstation and Mrsool, with a specific focus on their pick-up features. Through data analysis and user journey reviews, I identified that users often struggle with visualizing nearby options or grouping restaurants in busy areas.

I worked closely with the product manager to define high-level goals for the Map View, which included implementing clustering logic to group restaurant pins on the map when zoomed out, and enabling smoother location-based exploration. We also scoped out location grouping behavior to ensure that the map UI would remain clean and usable in areas with many overlapping restaurants.

Using Figma, I began sketching possible interaction patterns, and collaborated with the backend team to understand the feasibility of these features based on their existing APIs. We also prepared a rough prototype to help guide discussions with stakeholders.

Challenges Faced:

This was my first time dealing with geospatial clustering concepts, and simplifying that experience into an intuitive user flow was intellectually challenging.

Understanding how proximity logic translates into pin behavior on the map required several discussions with the development team and iterative adjustments in design.

Skills Learned and Benefits:

- Gained hands-on experience in feature scoping from a UX perspective.
- Learned how to collaborate with PMs to write early design requirements.
- Developed a stronger understanding of geolocation-based interfaces and user navigation expectations, **informed by the competitive analysis.**

Completed Hours: 23 hours

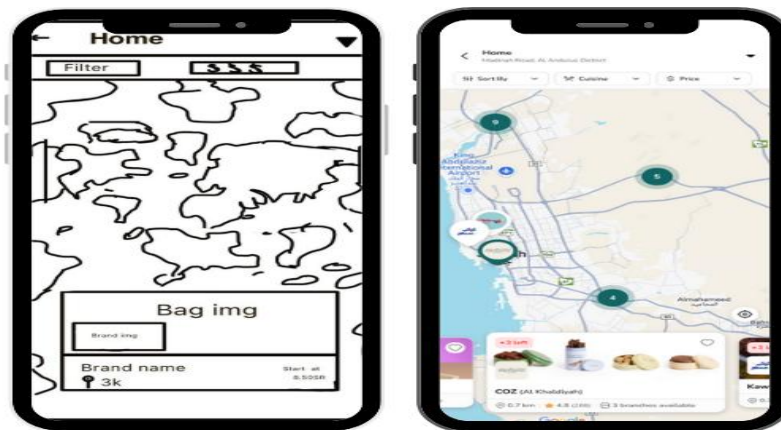


Figure 6 Map View feature

Week 7 Progress Report

This week, I transitioned from research and scoping into **active collaboration with the engineering team** as the Map View began its development phase. I attended **daily standups** with both frontend and backend teams, where I observed task breakdowns, sprint adjustments, and blockers.

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standups with both frontend and backend teams, where I observed task breakdowns, sprint adjustments, and blockers.

In addition to QA sessions, I conducted internal usability testing with team members to gather feedback on the user interface and interaction flow. I created internal documentation to track feedback from these sessions, and iterated on visual elements to improve clarity, such as label placement, zoom sensitivity, and pin sizing.

Throughout the week, I provided UX feedback in real-time to ensure the technical implementation stayed aligned with the original design vision. At the same time, I adjusted some designs based on technical constraints, learning how to balance vision and feasibility.

Challenges Faced:

It was often difficult to ensure that the UX intentions behind certain map behaviors (like smart zoom or auto-centering) were understood and maintained by the engineering team. Some features required adjustments because of platform limitations, which led to compromises in design.

Skills Learned and Benefits:

- Deepened my knowledge of **frontend-backend collaboration** and agile communication.
- Practiced **QA testing** and logging interaction bugs.
- Learned how to iterate on design during the implementation phase under real constraints.

Completed Hours: 23 hours



Figure 7Heatmap showing internal users' interactions with the new Home Screen design during usability testing.



Figure 8 Results of the internal team survey regarding the aspects of the new Home Screen that they liked the most.

Week 8 Progress Report

This week focused on evaluating and improving the **in-app reviews feature**, a critical component that influences restaurant trust and decision-making. My first task

was to collect feedback and data from multiple sources: review submission flows, post-order prompts, and the restaurant profile screens.

Through this evaluation, I discovered inconsistencies in the logic and order of how reviews were displayed, as well as how outdated reviews remained visible. I identified opportunities to increase visibility of relevant reviews and improve the user prompt flow so users are encouraged to leave reviews at the right moments.

I created a presentation of recommendations that included new wireframes, logic changes, and examples from competitors. I also worked with the QA team to simulate the review flow and document issues in display conditions and data syncing.

Challenges Faced:

Balancing improvements without disrupting the existing review system was complex. Since this feature is already active and relied on by users, proposing changes had to be approached carefully and justified by both data and UX principles.

Skills Learned and Benefits:

- Strengthened my skills in **user behavior analysis**.
- Gained experience in **feature refinement** based on real-world data.
- Learned how to collaborate with developers on **timing, logic, and display rules**.

Completed Hours: 23 hours

Week 9 Progress Report

As my internship neared its end, I spent the final week consolidating everything I had worked on and learned. I helped prepare the **quarterly roadmap** for the product team by identifying areas that needed further research or improvement. I also compiled a detailed summary of my **learning outcomes**, including reflections on my strengths, weaknesses, and growth as a UX practitioner.

In addition, I finalized all required internal documentation, uploaded reports to the team workspace, and helped deliver a **retrospective presentation** highlighting key UX wins during the summer. This process not only wrapped up my internship, but also allowed me to reflect deeply on the overall impact of my work and how it fit into the larger product goals.

I also began preparing for my university **final presentation**, ensuring that visuals and reporting formats aligned with academic requirements.

Challenges Faced:

Condensing nine weeks of diverse, evolving tasks into a clear story was challenging. It required thoughtful curation and reflection to find the most meaningful insights and present them coherently.

Skills Learned and Benefits:

- Improved **storytelling and reflection** in a professional setting.
- Practiced creating **impact summaries** and reporting key takeaways.
- Learned how to document internship contributions in a structured way.

Completed Hours: 23 hours

Conclusion

Over the course of my internship at Barakah, I gained substantial experience in UX research, product design, and cross-functional collaboration. The opportunity to contribute to real features—such as the Rewards Challenge, Home Screen personalization, and Map View—allowed me to apply theoretical knowledge in a real-world setting.

I developed skills in user journey mapping, usability testing, behavioral analytics using Mixpanel, and writing clear product documentation. I also learned to manage real-world constraints such as limited time, technical feasibility, and evolving priorities. Working alongside experienced designers, developers, and product managers gave me a broader understanding of how design decisions are made and executed in an agile environment.

This internship not only strengthened my technical and research abilities, but also enhanced my communication, problem-solving, and project planning skills. Most importantly, it deepened my appreciation for user-centered design and its role in building meaningful, impact-driven digital experiences.

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